

Indentation and line continuation

In executing long commands, you can enhance the readability by allowing the command to spread in multiple lines. Here is a quick demonstration of this fact.

```
[me@linuxbox ~]$ find playground \( -type f -not -perm 0600
-exec
chmod 0600 '{}' ';' \) -or \( -type d -not -perm 0700
-exec chmod
0700 '{}' ';' \)
```

This command can be quite complex to understand at first look. So in a script, it might be more suitable to understand if written in the following way.

```
find playground \
 \( \
 -type f \
 -not -perm 0600 \
 -exec chmod 0600 '{}' ';' \
 \) \
 -or \
 \( \
 -type d \
 -not -perm 0700 \
 -exec chmod 0700 '{}' ';' \
 \)
```

So you can apply line continuations and indentation to make the commands more readable. Similarly, this technique can be used in the command line too. One significant difference you should note between a command line and script is that script can use tab characters for indentation while the command line uses tabs to achieve completion.

Conclusion

Shell scripting is an easy way to avoid repetitive tasks and offers automation to a certain level. There are specific rules and permissions for writing shell scripts to perform ideally. You can use several tricks to format scripts for ease of working. Still, you have to be precise; otherwise, any small misjudgment or error can harm the program. Sometimes a script can be slow in execution depending on the complexity of the tasks. 